

Tactical Play and Archetypes

Tactical Roles

[DMG] – Damage Dealer

[TANK] – Defender / Threat Soaker

[CTRL] – Control / Status / Zone Denial

[SUP] – Support / Healing / Buffing

[MOB] – Mobility / Harassment

Tactics 101: Fundamentals for New Players

1. AP is Everything

Action Points = What You Can Do This Turn.

- Every move, attack, spell, or skill costs AP.
- **Plan around your AP limit**—don't burn it all unless you're sure you're safe.
- If you move, attack, and dodge every turn, you'll burn fast—**learn to cycle effort**.

Pro Tip: Sometimes doing *less* is tactical—save AP to react or reposition later.

2. Your Role Dictates Your Risk

Ask: "Should I be in the front, middle, or back?"

- [TANK]s stand in front and block movement or attention.
- [DMG] characters move in, strike hard, and move out—or position where they won't get focused.
- [SUP] and [CTRL] characters should avoid the front unless built to handle it.
- [MOB] archetypes should stay on the flanks, never the middle.

Stand where your role belongs. Your effectiveness *and survival* depend on it.

3. Control the Map, Not Just the Enemy

Terrain, choke points, height, and line of sight matter.

- Hold narrow corridors with tanky characters.
- Push enemies into hazards or deny access to your healer.
- Create "zones of threat" with traps, AOE spells, or weapon reach.

Pro Tip: If the enemy *has* to move through your attack range, you're already winning.

4. Keep Your Threat Profile in Mind

Who's the most dangerous target right now? It's not always you.

- **Enemies focus based on threat.** If you deal massive damage, prepare to be targeted.
 - If you're a summoner or support character, you might be ignored—use that to your advantage.
 - Control how much attention you draw. High-threat characters should have escape plans.
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5. Use the Action Triangle: Threat – Tempo – Support

Think of combat like a triangle of roles:

- **Threat:** Damage dealers who apply pressure.
- **Tempo:** Controllers who slow, bind, or stall.
- **Support:** Healers or buffers who keep others effective.

You win fights when all three flow together:

- Controllers make enemies vulnerable
 - Damage dealers finish them
 - Supports keep both moving
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6. Flanking and Positioning Matter

Back attacks, crossfire, and pinning are deadly. Use them.

- Flanking applies bonuses or denies defenses in many cases.
 - Use allies and summons to block escape or isolate targets.
 - Even without extra damage, **limiting options is a win.**
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7. Reaction Tokens Are Defensive Gold

DT = “Don’t Touch Me.”

- Don’t burn all your AP if you can’t defend yourself.
 - A single DT can be the difference between surviving a round or getting knocked down.
 - If you know you're getting hit soon, **save DT instead of chasing one more hit.**
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8. Synergy Wins Combats, Not Solo Plays

Pair up—create combos.

- Tactician marks an enemy → Executioner crits for massive damage.
- Controller stuns a group → Invoker drops a fire zone.
- Warden guards a space → Summoner floods it with durable allies.

If everyone does their own thing, you get chaos.

If everyone stacks, combos, and plans around each other? **You get victories.**

9. Know When to Pull Back

Retreating is not failure. It's repositioning.

- Many fights are lost because someone stays in too long.
 - If you're at 1 HP and out of RT, you're a liability.
 - Use movement actions, terrain, or a summoned distraction to disengage.
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10. Finish Enemies Efficiently

Leave no stragglers.

- Wounded enemies still take actions. Don't let them.
 - If someone's bleeding and nearly dead, clean it up fast.
 - Don't get greedy for damage—**focus fire and secure kills.**
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Tactical Archetype Decision Tree

What do you want to do most in combat?

"I want to protect others or draw enemy attention."

Do you want to absorb damage personally, or protect an area/team from a distance?

- *Soak hits head-on and lead the charge* → **Vanguard [TANK]**
 - *Stand your ground and shield allies with auras or barriers* → **Warden [TANK / SUP]**
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"I want to deal as much damage as possible."

How do you want to deal damage?

- *Get in close and tear things apart* →
 - *With brute force and burst* → **Striker [DMG]**
 - *By finishing off weakened foes* → **Executioner [DMG]**
 - *Using graceful chained motion* → **Wardancer [MOB / DMG]**
- *Stay at a distance and snipe or bombard* →
 - *With weapons* → **Archer [DMG]**
 - *With magic* → **Invoker [DMG / CTRL]**
 - *By channeling raw energy* → **Channeler [SUP / DMG]**

- *Let summoned creatures do the fighting* →
 - *With overwhelming force* → **Summoner [DMG]**
 - *By empowering them tactically* → **Summoner [CTRL / SUP]**
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"I want to control the battlefield or mess with enemies."

How do you want to exert control?

- *Through debuffs, terrain denial, or slow control* → **Controller [CTRL]**
 - *Using illusions, decoys, or teleporting trickery* → **Phantom [MOB / CTRL]**
 - *With traps, explosives, and sabotage* → **Saboteur [CTRL / DMG]**
 - *By commanding or guiding allies into position* → **Tactician [SUP / CTRL]**
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"I want to support my allies directly."

What kind of support?

- *Healing and cleansing* → **Healer [SUP]**
 - *Empowering or coordinating the team* → **Tactician [SUP / CTRL]**
 - *Channeling magical power or restoring SP* → **Channeler [SUP / DMG]**
 - *Guarding specific allies with defensive auras* → **Warden [SUP / TANK]**
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"I want to move constantly or strike from unexpected places."

What's your goal with movement?

- *Harass and reposition frequently* → **Skirmisher [MOB / DMG]**
 - *Teleport, vanish, or illusion-hop* → **Phantom [MOB / CTRL]**
 - *Blend elegant movement with melee flow* → **Wardancer [MOB / DMG]**
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Advanced Combat Tactics

1. Turn Cycling: "Act, Threaten, Reset"

Rotate pressure across turns to avoid burnout.

Cycle Strategy:

- **Turn 1:** Use 60–80% of your AP to strike or set up zones.
- **Turn 2:** Shift focus to defense, movement, or support.

- **Turn 3:** Return to pressure with full pools and safe positioning.

Why it works:

It prevents you from overextending. It forces the enemy to overcommit to get to you. It keeps your RT and SP sustainable.

2. DT Baiting and Burnouts

A foe with no Reaction Token is prey.

How to bait RT:

- Approach threateningly without committing to full AP usage.
- Use low-AP harassment attacks that pressure without all-in risk.
- Force them to dodge → then ally follows up with real attack.

Why it works:

DT is limited and precious. Once spent, that enemy is exposed—*timing is everything*. Your goal is to **draw RT before your real move lands**.

3. Threat Layering

Stack pressure sources until the enemy has to break.

Examples:

- **Frontline melee + ranged pressure:** Forces hard choices—can't block both.
- **Zone control + burst threat:** They must move, but moving exposes them.
- **Summons + stealth flanks:** Divide attention or overwhelm one side.

Execution tip: Always ask:

"If they dodge me, who hits next?"
"If they stay, who controls their exit?"

4. Action Loops and Synergy Chains

Use party builds to loop effects and feed off each other.

Examples:

- **Tactician marks → Executioner gains bonus vs. marked → Channeler recharges Executioner SP.**
- **Controller freezes ground → Phantom uses slip terrain to vanish → Saboteur detonates escape path.**
- **Warden holds corridor → Healer wards Warden → Invoker casts AoE on clustered foes.**

Why it works:

This multiplies each action's value. You stop trading 1-for-1 and start trading **1-for-3**.

5. Edge Control and Lane Theory

Own the battlefield's edges and flow zones.

Edges:

- Flanking routes, corners, or elevation
- Good for skirmishers, archers, and phantoms

Lanes:

- Predictable enemy paths (corridors, chokepoints)
- Good for tanks, saboteurs, and controllers

Play the field, not the target. Control where enemies *want* to be.

6. Feints and Delay Triggers

Trick enemies into wasting AP or reacting prematurely.

Feint Examples:

- Move into range without attacking, then ready a DT.
- Use a visible spell cast that is easily interrupted—*but hides your ally's real action*.
- Set a trap in a place that only looks important.

Goal:

Draw DT, interrupt spells, or cause premature resource burns.

7. Pin & Collapse

Use 2+ allies to box in an enemy with nowhere safe to run.

Step-by-step:

1. Skirmisher or phantom pressures from behind.
2. Tank or striker engages from front or side.
3. Controller slows their movement or blocks escape tile.

Now the target:

- Can't run
- Has no RT
- Takes damage or status regardless

This wins duels, **breaks bosses**, and ends elite units.

8. Tempo Flipping

Suddenly reverse momentum by punishing an overextended enemy.

Look for:

- An enemy who used too much AP
- A key DT already spent
- One isolated enemy out of support range

Then:

- Collapse your team on them
- Use crowd control or burst
- Force a break in formation

Why it works:

It takes one overextension to swing momentum. Punish it fast.

9. Kill the Engine, Not the Threat

Sometimes the damage dealer isn't the real danger.

Targets to prioritize:

- The **healer** keeping them alive
- The **controller** who slows your reactions
- The **summoner** endlessly spawning pressure
- The **channeler** feeding SP to the team

Remove their support and the whole formation breaks.

10. Predict Patterns and Plan Counters

Enemies follow logic—exploit it.

Ask:

- What do they always do after taking damage?
- Do they favor one side or target certain roles?
- Who always acts after the tank?

Then break it.

- Stun their initiator.
- Kill their follow-up.
- Force them to burn RT before their combo.

Control the flow = control the fight.

Team Composition Theory

Building a Functional Party

1. The 3-Role Core: Threat, Tempo, Support

At the heart of every effective team lies this **foundational triangle**:

Role	Responsibility	Typical Archetypes
Threat	Deal damage and pressure the enemy	Striker, Archer, Executioner, Invoker
Tempo	Control the flow of combat	Controller, Phantom, Tactician, Saboteur
Support	Sustain and empower the team	Healer, Channeler, Warden, Tactician

A balanced 3-person team includes **one from each role**.

2. The 5-Person Standard Team Formula

In most full-party scenarios, aim for the following:

Slot	Role Focus	Suggested Types
Slot 1	Frontline Anchor	Vanguard, Warden, Spellblade
Slot 2	Primary Threat	Striker, Executioner, Invoker
Slot 3	Control	Controller, Phantom, Saboteur
Slot 4	Support Engine	Healer, Channeler, Tactician
Slot 5	Flex / Skirmish	Skirmisher, Summoner, Wardancer

Flex slot can be adjusted based on expected threats, terrain, or campaign tone (combat-heavy vs. exploration-heavy). Additional member could copy any role they like.

3. Avoiding Composition Pitfalls

Common problems in new groups—and how to fix them.

Pitfall	What Happens	How to Fix
All Threat, No Control	Great opening turns, then chaos	Add a controller or tactician
Too Many Frontliners	Movement becomes cramped, poor spacing	Mix in ranged or mobile characters
Only Passive Support	No pressure to deter aggression	Use an active-support build (e.g. Channeler or Summoner)

Redundant Damage Types	Enemy can resist entire team	Mix melee, ranged, elemental, and summon-based sources
No Reaction Planning	Enemies always land hits	Add a skirmisher or phantom to force RT drain

4. Synergy Patterns to Build Around

Here are powerful **composition patterns** to intentionally design around:

a) The Control Funnel

Lock movement + AoE combo burst

- **Controller + Vanguard + Invoker**
- Example: Warden pins → Controller slows → Invoker nukes

b) Execution Chain

Status + target mark + finisher

- **Tactician + Controller + Executioner**
- Example: Mark → stun → execute

c) Double Tempo Team

Overwhelm with control & reposition

- **Phantom + Tactician + Channeler + Striker**
- Great for PvP or elite enemy attrition fights

d) Summon Wall Composition

Delay frontline with disposable allies

- **Summoner + Warden + Healer**
- Excellent for dungeon delves or attrition-heavy missions

e) Ranged Collapse Team

Draw enemies forward into death

- **Archer + Saboteur + Spellblade + Controller**
 - Best on maps with corridors or visibility zones
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5. Scaling for 2-Player Teams

You'll never get everything—prioritize synergy.

- Pair **Threat + Support** → Striker + Healer
 - Pair **Tempo + Flex** → Phantom + Channeler
 - Or build two hybrids: **Spellblade + Tactician**
 - Use **summons or pets** to fill in gaps (fake a tank or healer)
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6. Party Questions to Ask at Creation

To help a party self-balance at session zero:

- Who's drawing the most attention? (Do we have a tank?)
 - Who is generating the most RT drain or crowd control?
 - Do we have any source of healing, even light?
 - What's our emergency disengage plan?
 - Who handles terrain or verticality?
 - Can we deal with magic-resistant enemies?
 - What happens if we're separated or cornered?
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Archetypes Examples

The Archetypes are only for guidance. Explore many options, and make characters far outside the scope of these basic archetypes. Mix and match, just be aware of ability synergies.

[TANK] Vanguard

Summary: Frontline threat that draws attention, disrupts formations, and absorbs punishment.
Common Traits & Builds: High BDY, heavy armor, taunt or knockdown effects, AoE melee skills.
Ideal Stats/Skills: BDY, Shielding, Martial Mastery, Athletics
Equipment: Shields, spears, heavy armor, war picks
Strengths: Zone control, durability, aggression with survivability
Weaknesses: Low mobility, vulnerable to flanking, struggles vs. ranged or elusive foes
Variants: Bulwark (pure tank), Breaker (CC-focused), Relentless (regen- or retaliation-based)

[DMG] Striker

Summary: High-damage melee combatant focused on mobility and burst.
Common Traits & Builds: High SPD or BDY, dual weapons or greatweapons, status infliction
Ideal Stats/Skills: BDY or SPD, Combat Reflexes, Stealth, Acrobatics
Equipment: Daggers, axes, short blades, medium armor
Strengths: Burst damage, target deletion, ambush
Weaknesses: Glass cannon, needs positioning, vulnerable if isolated
Variants: Duelist (1v1 finesse), Ravager (AoE damage), Bleeder (DoT focus)

[DMG] Archer

Summary: Ranged physical attacker who pressures enemies with sustained fire.
Common Traits & Builds: High SPD or SPT, precision or multi-shot builds, elevation use

Ideal Stats/Skills: SPD or SPT, Archery, Perception, Tracking
Equipment: Longbows, crossbows, elemental ammunition
Strengths: Safe positioning, constant pressure, synergy with spotters
Weaknesses: Poor in melee, needs line of sight, arrow consumption
Variants: Sniper (single-target burst), Skirmisher (hit-and-run), Suppressor (debuffing)

[DMG]/[CTRL]/[TANK] Spellblade

Summary: Hybrid melee-magic user combining weapon strikes with elemental or soul energy.
Common Traits & Builds: Balanced stats, elemental affinities, dual-role versatility
Ideal Stats/Skills: MND + BDY/SPT, Elemental Weaponry, Runic Combat, Imbuing
Equipment: Channeling weapons, enchanted armor, elemental runes
Strengths: Flexibility, damage variety, enchant scaling
Weaknesses: Split investment, complex AP management, affinity counters
Variants: Arcblade (pure elemental), Soulforged (SP-based), Hexblade (curse synergy)

[DMG] Invoker

Summary: Long-range spellcaster focused on elemental or arcane bombardment.
Common Traits & Builds: High MND or SPT, strong affinities, AoE or chain spells
Ideal Stats/Skills: MND or SPT, Elemental Affinity, Spellcraft, Focus
Equipment: Wands, staves, talismans, light armor
Strengths: Burst AoE, range control, elemental counters
Weaknesses: Low HP, long casts, dependent on SP and line of sight
Variants: Blaster (direct damage), Field Mage (terrain effects), Chaincaster (multi-hit)

[CTRL] Controller

Summary: Battlefield manipulator specializing in terrain, statuses, and movement denial.
Common Traits & Builds: Focus on debuffs, zone denial, manipulation
Ideal Stats/Skills: SPT or MND, Hexing, Weatherworking, Gravitycraft
Equipment: Totems, glyphs, terrain-altering devices
Strengths: Obstruction, tempo control, soft CC
Weaknesses: Low burst, relies on team synergy, indirect impact
Variants: Disabler, Trapmaster, Illusionist

[SUP] Healer

Summary: Keeps allies alive through direct healing, buffs, and status cleansing.
Common Traits & Builds: High SPT or MND, aura-based, uses emotions or divine magic
Ideal Stats/Skills: SPT or MND, Empathy, Purification, Spirit Weaving
Equipment: Prayer beads, staves, soulstone relics
Strengths: Sustain, morale support, debuff cleansing
Weaknesses: Limited offense, requires protection, SP-hungry
Variants: Empath (emotional), Priest (divine), Herbalist (tonic-based)

[DMG]/[CTRL]/[SUP] Summoner

Summary: Commands minions, constructs, or spirit allies to overwhelm or distract foes.
Common Traits & Builds: Strong soul or elemental affinity, tactical deployments
Ideal Stats/Skills: SPT or MND, Summoning, Binding, Necro-cultivation
Equipment: Soul cores, bone charms, golemic interface
Strengths: Action economy, frontline distraction, delayed effects
Weaknesses: Weak direct actions, setup time, loss of summons hurts output
Variants: Swarmcaller, Spirit Binder, Construct Lord

[SUP][CTRL]Tactician

Summary: Support/control hybrid with bonus effects from flanking, positioning, or commands.

Common Traits & Builds: Leadership focus, command-based effects, AP economy booster

Ideal Stats/Skills: MND or SPT, Tactics, Command, Rallying Cry

Equipment: Battlefield flags, signaling horns, map markers

Strengths: Ally synergy, extra actions, repositioning

Weaknesses: Weak alone, relies on team composition, needs foresight

Variants: Warcaller, Strategist, Inspiring Leader

[MOB] Skirmisher

Summary: Highly mobile combatant who focuses on harassment, scouting, and flank punishment.

Common Traits & Builds: High SPD, mobility effects, concealment

Ideal Stats/Skills: SPD, Stealth, Climbing, Acrobatics

Equipment: Light armor, shortbows, slings, thrown weapons

Strengths: Hit-and-run, hard to pin down, flank disruptor

Weaknesses: Low staying power, AP drains fast, soft stats

Variants: Scout, Rogue, Shadowstepper

[DMG] Executioner

Summary: Finisher who specializes in punishing injured or debuffed targets.

Common Traits & Builds: High critical bonus damage, executes below HP thresholds, often partners with controllers or strikers.

Ideal Stats/Skills: BDY / MND, Combat Reflexes, Death Magic, Affinity-channeled damage

Equipment: Heavy blades, cursed weapons, draining gloves

Strengths: High burst vs. wounded targets, synergy with status teams, critical hit optimization

Weaknesses: Low opening power, reliant on setup by others, vulnerable if focused

Variants: Deathdealer (soul-rending), Butcher (cleave finishers), Vengeant (revenge mechanic)

Player Notes: Your job is to eliminate anything weakened—fast. Critical bonus synergy and conditional multipliers make you deadly in follow-up attacks.

[MOB]/[DMG] Wardancer

Summary: Agile melee specialist focused on repositioning and chaining abilities.

Common Traits & Builds: SPD-focused evasion builds, reactive parry chains, emphasis on continuous flow and enemy misdirection.

Ideal Stats/Skills: SPD, Acrobatics, Flow Mastery, Reactive Guard

Equipment: Light blades, flexible armor, kinetic wraps

Strengths: Superior movement economy, high dodge rate, graceful multi-attacks

Weaknesses: Low durability, action chain can be broken by control effects, relies on uninterrupted momentum

Variants: Bladewhirl (AoE), Stepfighter (precision-focused), Ripostist (counterattacker)

Player Notes: Dance between foes, redirect aggression, and chain actions with elegance. Your power is rhythm and timing.

[CTRL]/[DMG]Saboteur

Summary: Terrain controller and ambush specialist who uses traps, bombs, and hazards.

Common Traits & Builds: Stealth-heavy, uses engineering and alchemy to control space or deny enemy movement.

Ideal Stats/Skills: MND / SPD, Engineering, Tinkering, Stealth, Alchemy

Equipment: Caltrops, mines, bombs, glyph packs

Strengths: Terrain control, high damage if prepped, anti-formation

Weaknesses: Setup time required, fragile if caught, friendly fire risk

Variants: Trapmaster (zone denial), Demolitionist (explosives), Injector (poison tech)

Player Notes: Control the battlefield through fear, fire, and misfortune. The terrain is your ally—and the enemy's doom.

[SUP]/[DMG] Channeler

Summary: Magical amplifier or raw-energy conduit that fuels allies or detonates overloaded power.

Common Traits & Builds: High-SP builds, magic chaining, energy transfer or elemental burst overload.

Ideal Stats/Skills: SPT / MND, Focus, Soulweaving, Elemental Resonance

Equipment: Conduits, crystal foci, linked soul devices

Strengths: Ally synergy, flexible output (support or damage), energy cycling potential

Weaknesses: SP dependent, fragile, vulnerable to silence/disruption

Variants: Harmonic (buffs/auras), Overcharger (wild casting), Battery (SP generation & redirection)

Player Notes: You serve as a magical amplifier or battery. Push allies past limits or burn everything through raw energy.

[TANK]/[SUP] Warden

Summary: Defensive support that protects zones, buffs allies, and punishes enemies for intruding.

Common Traits & Builds: Heavy armor, support-focused auras, passive DR bonuses, slow but unshakable.

Ideal Stats/Skills: BDY / SPT, Barrier Magic, Empathy, Guardian's Oath

Equipment: Heavy plate, aura anchors, passive shield triggers

Strengths: Team defense, reliable positioning, sanctified ground effects

Weaknesses: Poor mobility, limited offense, vulnerable to control displacement

Variants: Anchor (area denial), Bastion (ally defense), Devout (faith-based protection)

Player Notes: You don't just block blows—you sanctify ground. Fortify allies and make locations sacred.

[MOB]/[CTRL] Phantom

Summary: Elusive disruptor using illusions, decoys, and phase mechanics to mislead and strike.

Common Traits & Builds: High evasion and concealment, mirror/decoy effects, teleportation or phasing tricks.

Ideal Stats/Skills: SPT / SPD, Illusion, Phasewalking, Shadowcraft

Equipment: Displacement cloaks, flickerblades, reflection charms

Strengths: Extremely hard to pin down, forces misplays, natural counter to targeting

Weaknesses: Weak vs. AoE and detection, low HP, can be shut down with true vision

Variants: Doppel (decoy control), Haunt (fear/terror), Phaseblade (teleport attacker)

Player Notes: You exist at the edge of perception. Divide attention, fake your position, and slip through danger.